

Kenneth William Pirman

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PROGRAMMING EXPERIENCE

Member of Technical Staff — Character.AI

June 2024 – Current | New York City, US

Technical Lead, Design Engineering, Core Chat

- Lead a team of Design Engineers to ship a complete redesign of the entire Chat Surface.
- Shipped daily to tens of millions of users, millions of devices.
- Prove UX features out through rigorous weekly experimentation.

Senior Software Engineer — Nexthink

March 2021 – October 2023 | Lausanne, CH

Lead frontend engineer on Nexthink Flow, a canvas-based no-code workflow automation tool.

- Designed, developed, and maintained cross-feature TypeScript and React libraries and SDKs.
- Spearheaded cross-team product initiatives to consolidate separate features into shared components.
- Ensured product quality with unit, component, and end-to-end testing; integrated a11y compliance strategies.

Senior UI Engineer — Blue Brain Project

March 2018 – February 2021 | Geneva, CH

Seniormost frontend contributor for the neuroinformatics lab's open-source data and visualisation platform, Nexus.

- Created WebGL-based visualisation tools for neuron morphologies.
- Developed data visualisation tools, such as epidemiological growth models, for NGOs.
- Implemented domain-specific Elastic-Search indices and React search interfaces.

PROJECTS

Hello Terrain — hello-terrain.kenny.wtf (14+ GitHub Stars)

High performance open-world terrain engine for the three.js ecosystem.

- Makes use of WebGPU compute stages for a modern Unreal-like terrain workflow.
- Developed a library called Work to manage compute dependencies.

Hello Worlds — worlds.kenny.wtf (100+ GitHub Stars)

TypeScript-based suite of open-source libraries to render realistically-sized planets at varying levels of detail, from space-to-ground, in real-time.

- Makes use of high-performance web technologies, such as SharedArrayBuffers and WebWorker pools.
- Offers both React and Three.js npm packages for public consumption.

Terrain-Synth — github.com/kenjinp/terrain-synth (60+ GitHub Stars)

Machine-learning-based terrain tool that generates elevation maps from real-earth GIS datasets.

- Designed and trained custom WGAN to produce heightmaps in less than 1s inference time in the browser.
- Implemented volumetric shadows and atmospheric scattering in a custom shader.

EDUCATION

Recurse Center

November 2023 – February 2024 | Brooklyn, NY

Explored generative machine learning, graphics programming, and high-performance web tech.

University of Texas

Bachelor of Arts, Linguistics, May 2012 | Austin, TX

Specialisation in Mandarin film and literature, translation.

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Professional Translator (Mandarin) — Beijing, CN | June 2012 – March 2015